

Research question and design

The Canopy project research question is whether a shaded reading courtyard improves afternoon study comfort. This is a fictional teaching study, not real scientific evidence. The study uses a two-week crossover design. Twenty-four adult volunteers participate. Each volunteer attends one shaded session and one unshaded session. Session order is randomized.

Measures and schedule

The primary outcome is self-reported study comfort on a seven-point scale. Temperature is recorded every ten minutes using the same sensor. Sessions take place from 14:00 to 16:00. The study records no names in the analysis table; each participant receives a random code. The project budget is 1200 credits.

Consent and limitations

Participants may withdraw at any time without giving a reason. Raw coded observations are retained for 90 days, then deleted. The protocol does not measure exam grades or long-term learning. The sample comes from one campus, which limits generalization. Participants cannot be blinded to the presence of shade.